

1 Which term describes the interaction between the biotic and abiotic factors in the environment?

- A Community
- B Ecosystem
- C Habitat
- D Species

Your answer

[1]

2 The grasslands of Africa are an example of an ecosystem.

Fig. 11.1 shows a food chain within this ecosystem.

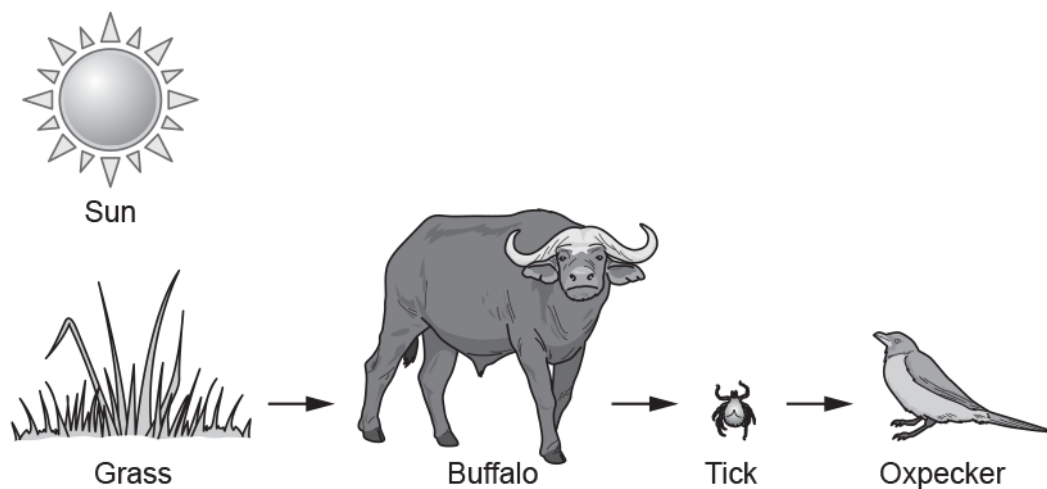


Fig. 11.1

Name an example of each of the following in the food chain shown in Fig. 11.1.

i. A primary consumer.

[1]

ii. An abiotic component.

[1]

3 Why are microorganisms described as a biotic factor and soil moisture as an abiotic factor?

[1]

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Mark Scheme

Question			Answer/Indicative content	Marks	Guidance
1			B	1 (AO 1.1)	
			Total	1	
2		i	Buffalo ✓	1 (AO 2.1)	<u>Examiner's Comments</u> Most candidates could correctly identify the buffalo as the primary consumer.
		ii	Sun / (Sun)light ✓	1 (AO 2.1)	IGNORE temperature / heat <u>Examiner's Comments</u> This question proved far more challenging than part (i), with many candidates stating that grass was the abiotic component.
			Total	2	
3			Microorganisms are living and (soil) moisture is a non-living/physical factor ✓	1 (AO 1.1)	ALLOW microorganisms are living and (soil) moisture is not ALLOW biotic factors are living things and abiotic factors are not ALLOW water for soil moisture IGNORE environmental factor <u>Examiner's Comments</u> This question was successfully answered by the majority of candidates demonstrating knowledge of the key terms biotic and abiotic.
			Total	1	